GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

July 25th, 2025
Week 30
Volume 274, Issue 1195

Highlights:

- **LNGs again.**
- **Bottom out?**
- **Glimmers?**
- **HKC rules.**
- **Busier times await.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"Success is getting what you want; happiness is wanting what you get."

– W. Kinsella

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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GLIMMER OF LIFE?

As we stand on the eve of Week 31 this 2025, global market turmoil continues unimpeded as wars rage, freight markets firm, economies flutter, and oil, currencies, and steel prices all fluctuate in a wavering tandem, delivering headaches along the way for all on this ride. While Trump announces further deals with Japan and the EU late on Sunday, his sketchy past is what keeps hammering this administration down, which itself is scrambling to do damage control vs. attempting to fix the state of the U.S. economy that has seen the U.S. Dollar weakening against key global competitors, whilst strengthening against virtually all recycling destinations. U.S. inflation meanwhile climbs from 2.4% to 2.7% in June as Turkey, India, Bangladesh, and even Pakistan all report declines in their respective inflations. Oil futures also declined 1.3% to settle at USD 65.2 / barrel on the back of said U.S. trade deals, in addition to concerns of an oversupply of oil as Trump announces the possibility of easing sanctions against Venezuela that could add a reported 200,00 barrels of oil to global supply-chain. The Baltic Exchange's main sea freight index meanwhile reported another improvement this week with the Cape index surging 1% of its total annual value via a 24% gain just this week, all while the Panamax and Supramax indices confoundingly fell 2.3% & 0.3% respectively.

Notwithstanding, glimmers of life seem to be emerging from the Indian sub-continent ship recycling markets as offers on the large(r) LDT LNGs making the rounds (including various other types of tonnage) surpassed most expectations this week. But what remained the most impressive (and as forecasted in weeks prior), Alang recyclers have been the ones to take in virtually all of the market (and private) fixtures as Alang's anchorage was 'fully loaded' this week. This may be a sign that the markets have likely bottomed out, but the situation may remain in a state of statis until the end of next week before any movements can be expected from any of the sub-continent markets, especially after the recent and significant decline of about USD 60/LDT in residual values from the highs of USD 400s/LDT seen at the start of the year, including the massive USD 600/LDT seen just 12 months prior. Moreover, we have also seen prices decline below USD 400/LDT during the historically slower monsoon / summer months as several deals are still being fixed at those levels in 2025 as well.

Finally, while the adoption of the Hong Kong Convention (HKC) for recycling has been one of the biggest changes (and challenges) in the history of ship recycling, it has also delivered a healthy dose of uncertainty surrounding the (changing) regulations and increased documentary requirements filtering through to the various waterfronts, with much infrastructure catch-up work still to be completed in both Bangladesh and (especially) Pakistan before the entire sub-continent falls in line with all of the HKCs requirements. Although a trickle of market candidates (aside from a plethora of large LDT LNG) candidates do seem to be making the rounds, supply concerns overall present challenges for recyclers as freight markets firm against the backdrop of pending tariff uncertainties once again. Yet, it is expected to a busier Q4 this year and once HKC formalities and requirements are more ingrained after yard upgrades are completed, there is a chance we may see activity in the sub-continent fire up once again.

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 30 of 2025 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

REALITY BITES!

Hurdles.

The Bangladeshi market still seems to be struggling with the adoption of the HKC and the resulting yard upgrades, yard inspections, class ratifications, ministry approvals, and ensuing documentary requirements seem to be collectively presenting a much large hurdle for ship owners, cash buyers, and ship recyclers far more than previously anticipated. As such, most local recyclers who have imported tonnage pre-HKC adoption seem to have temporarily satisfied their demand. Meanwhile, recycled ship's steel / steel product is still struggling to move from local recycling yards to domestic steel mills due to failure to initiate building / infrastructure projects by the frustratingly slow and lethargic interim government that has been in control for over a year now. And as the remainder of the marginal number of units at anchorage were delivered to their respective buyers this week, no fresh units have arrived locally, a forecasted reality for this market, especially in the short run.

Fundamentals funk.

Interestingly, most of the recent recycling sales including large LDT LNGs and even dry bulk units have bypassed Bangladeshi shores over the last month or so, onto the far more HKC-stable Indian market where prices remain ahead of Chattogram's offerings, which don't look like they have any potential to mark any improvements anytime soon. The Bangladeshi Taka has meanwhile resumed its fall against the U.S. Dollar once again, as it declined 65-basis points this week down to BDT 122.18. Even local steel plate prices were not spared from the brunt of recent steel fixtures by domestic steel mills at region USD 330/Ton, resulting in plate prices retreating nearly USD 2/Ton this week.

Bypassed.

Is this a sign of times for Bangladeshi vessel offerings through August as it has been through June thus far, with competing markets overshadowing the performance of Chattogram Choppers? It would certainly seem that way given that previous high-priced purchases are still languishing at local yards as local authorities have reportedly caused unexpected delays in granting cutting permissions amidst all of the new HKC requirements and ensuing red-tape between the various government departments.

The resulting delays in cutting / recycling of vessels and ensuing inability to resell recycled steel will stand to stimy the ability of local ship recyclers to even hold a chair at the bidding tables if this trend continues. And the aforementioned decline in the Taka was enough for the central bank to step in and stall the decline through monetary means. Just how long these controls hold remains to be seen given that growth projections for the country remain weak despite domestic inflation falling to 8.48% in June (down from nearly 11% at the start of the year), but could likely start to rise on the back of looming tariffs that stand to disrupt the economy overall as the year progresses

One-off sales?

Overall, other than one off sale of a juicy unit to an HKC approved yard, we do not anticipate much from Bangladesh in the coming week(s).

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

LNG KINGS!

After a series of Moss type LNG sales confirmed to local recyclers, it could be comfortably considered that India is at least getting back to a modicum of form this week, after what has been an extremely lacklustre few months of price declines and lethargic financial inertia that has seen this market at the 2nd and 3rd place on the market rankings a lot more than as historically has been the case.

Modicum of form.

And this week's activity was certainly a welcome surprise given that two large LDT LNG carriers were successfully committed to Alang buyers as ADNOC controlled GHASHA (33,406 LDT) and AL KHAZNAH (33,456 LDT) were both fixed on an en bloc basis, for an extremely firm USD 42.9 million (about USD 641.50/LDT) basis an 'as is' Malaysia delivery – the strong price being attributed to the large quantities of non-ferrous (including significant aluminium) on board these Moss type LNGS. India has certainly been the most sophisticated non-ferrous metals markets to trade with, even when they are lower placed against both their Pakistani and Bangladeshi competitors, making them the go-to market for stainless steel tankers, Moss type LNGs, and similar other non-ferrous rich units.

ADNOC sales.

And this return to form was also hard to be missed as Alang's waterfront remained a sight to behold this week, with 11 vessels (including a large LDT tanker) and over 107,000 tons of recycling tonnage having arrived the waterfront and a majority being delivered to their final owners. And this trend is likely expected to continue as Pakistani yards are still grappling with yard upgrades across the board and there has not been much positive news from the remainder of the Bangladeshi non-HKC yards that still have their works ongoing.

Local fundamentals too offer some hope as despite the Indian Rupee reacting like its sub-continent brethren against U.S. Dollar that saw it falling 40 basis points to Rs. 86.48, it was local steel plate prices that offered some Aspirin to local sentiments as levels reported firmed nearly USD 4/Ton this week and back to USD 432, offering an increased buffer on margins, especially on some of these recent and expensive deliveries. Moreover, with trade projections expected to grow in excess of 6.5% in 2025 on the back of increased domestic investments backed by trade deals concluded with the U.K. and a 2nd round of FTA talks with New Zealand that look increasingly promising, India could be in the limelight for the remainder of the year. Finally, Trump's growing assertions of reaching an agreement with India could also further the overall trajectory of the nation's economy.

Aspirin.

Overall, India will likely remain the go-to ship recycling destination through early August, perhaps all of it, making it a promising month for owners looking for prompt and hassle-free recycling-relief.

Promising August.

MARKET SALES REPORTED

VESSEL NAME	TYPE	LDT	REPORTED PRICE
GHASHA	LNG	33,406	USD 42.9 Mill Enbloc 'as is' Malaysia
AL KHAZNAH	LNG	33,456	USD 42.9 Mill Enbloc 'as is' Malaysia

PAKISTAN

SECURING SALES?

Best placed.

The Pakistani ship recycling market remains the best placed for yet another week and was even able to secure of series of bulkers this week, reportedly with significant quantities of bunkers remaining on board at the time of arrival. These sales are particularly interesting given that Gadani recyclers have traditionally been a selective group who tend not to veer too far left from the types of tonnage they have historically been comfortable recycling – and non-ferrous, Moss type LNGs, LPGs, and the likes have not made the cut for local recyclers, more often than not. Accordingly, markets witnessed both the RISING FALCON (5,694 LDT) and the RISING EAGLE (5,440 LDT) fixed en bloc to cash buyers` basis a likely Pakistan redelivery, at a decent USD 446/LT LDT including about 250 - 300 Tons of bunkers onboard at the time of delivery, contributing to almost USD 20/LDT to the purchase price of the vessel.

Bulkers sold.

With an increasing number of candidates expected to enter the markets in the fourth quarter of the year (sounds like 2024 wishes all over again) and as government bodies and end buyers finally start taking their respective HKC infrastructure upgrades seriously (including authorities issuing provisional DASR certificates to those yards that have committed to, and made notable progress at upgrade works to their yards), it is certainly a pleasure to have a competing Pakistan back at the bidding tables – albeit, like their Bangladeshi counterparts, restricted to a limited a number of local recyclers.

Marooned.

Domestic fundamentals aren't doing this market any favors at this time either as on the one hand, local steel plate prices stay marooned at region USD 615/Ton (still the highest in the industry), with no major market sales (of late) to take advantage of these impressive margins, while on the other hand, the Pakistani Rupee made a surprise bounce, firming about 55 basis points and end the week at PKR 283.20 against the U.S. Dollar. While certainly not a return to the saner days under PKR 280, it is hopefully firm motivation enough for the rest of the recycling community to join in their HKC efforts. And while Pakistan's economy and domestic stock exchange has faced increasing volatility over the recent past post-operation Sindoor, most businesses and even the government are wary of the way ahead with neighboring India.

Quick dry unit?

Notwithstanding, Gadani is certainly a destination to keep an eye out on, especially for owners looking to retire a dry unit quick in August.

MARKET SALES REPORTED

VESSEL NAME	TYPE	LDT	REPORTED PRICE
RISING FALCON	Bulker	5,694	USD 446/LT LDT (with about 250-300 Tons ROB)
RISING EAGLE	Bulker	5,440	USD 446/LT LDT (with about 250-300 Tons ROB)

TURKEY

UNCHANGED?

Weekly badgering.

While on the one hand, Aliaga's anchorages have been comparatively deserted for the most part of 2025 leaving the country's domestic ship recycling sector in "Airplane mode", on the other hand, the ongoing decline in Turkey's inflation rate has seen a drop from 42.12% back in January down to 35.15% back in June, which has reportedly resulted in the Turkish central bank favorably re-adjusting national interest / lending rates – a promising sign for domestic businesses in the short run.

But it has been the Lira that has been unable to escape its weekly badgering as it was reportedly subjected to another 50-basis point decline this week as well, ending it at TRY 40.56 against the U.S. Dollar. Import and local steel plate prices aren't doing very well either as they remain relatively unchanged and subdued over recent weeks.

Mercifully, the benchmark interest rate saw a 300-basis point reduction to 43% and might hopefully fuel the purchase of some of the cheaper, smaller, and regional end-of-life ships.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 30 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Pakistan	**Weak**	425 / LDT	445 / LDT	455 / LDT
2	India	**Weak**	415 / LDT	435 / LDT	445 / LDT
3	Bangladesh	**Weak**	405 / LDT	425 / LDT	435 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Weak**	250 / LDT	260 / LDT	270 / LDT

WEIRD ONES!!

- *That your car's fuel gauge has a little arrow next to the gas pump icon indicating which side your gas cap is on. Super handy when driving a rental or a new car.*
- *There are more bones in gummy worms than real worms. A common ingredient in gummy worms (unless specified to be vegan) is gelatin. Gelatin is made from animal bones, skin, and cartilage, which are processed for their collagen. Real worms have no bones, as they are invertebrates and actually have a hydrostatic skeleton. So, it looks like gummy worms really do have more "bones" than real worms do!*
- *The term 'bug' in computing has been around for a long time. The term was not commonly used until an actual bug landed on an electrical switch, causing the computer to malfunction. The term bug grew in popularity afterward and landed us where we are today. Also, when we find a bug in software, we apply a 'patch.' This comes from old cardex/punch card systems. If a punch card was punched in the wrong spot, you could fix it by applying a patch to the hole.*
- *There is a jellyfish that is 'immortal.' It returns back to pupa state and then again grows and repeats the cycle! Turritopsis dohrnii, aka the Immortal Jellyfish, can transform back into a polyp (the "child" phase of a jellyfish's life cycle) when they're physically damaged or starving. Essentially, the jellyfish "shrinks in on itself" and reabsorbs its tentacles, becoming a blob that soon transforms into a new polyp. From that, it matures and the new "medusae" buds off of it. The process is called transdifferentiation.*
- *Goodbye is a shortened form of 'God Be With You,' which people in Ye Olde England would say to each other.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
August 09 – Raksha Bandhan August 15 – Independence Day August 16 - Janmashtami	July 21 – July 29 August 08 – August 16 August 20 – August 27

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
August 05 – July Mass Uprising Day August 15 – National Mourning Day August 16 - Janmashtami	July 24 – July 27 August 09 – August 12 August 22 – August 25

BANK HOLIDAYS		
CHINA	**PAKISTAN**	**TURKEY**
No holidays until September	August 14 – Independence Day	August 30 – Victory Day

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ALANG - Port Position as of July 25, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Apia*	*34,066*	*LNG Carrier*	*Delivered July 22*
2	*Bontrup Pearl*	*11,377*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered July 26*
3	Conica Atlas	20,001	Oil Tanker	Arrived June 13
4	*Corso Marine*	*3,169*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered July 24*
5	*Gama II*	*12,857*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered July 24*
6	Green Egersund	2,975	Reefer	Arrived July 24
7	Lusay	2,979	Reefer	Arrived July 23
8	**Nirvana**	**9,623**	**Oil Tanker**	**Arrived May 07**
9	*Orient Brother*	*1,067*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered July 25*
10	***Run Fu 2***	***6,183***	***Bulk Carrier***	***Delivered July 17***
11	Senaz	2,921	Chemical Tanker	Delivered July 25
Total Tonnage		**107,218**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of July 25, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Gold*	*2,445*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered July 21*
2	*Meizan Maru*	*835*	*Cement Carrier*	*Delivered July 18*
3	*Rasi*	*30,771*	*LNG Carrier*	*Delivered July 13*
4	*Trawind Glory*	*1,026*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered July 23*
		35,077		

GADANI - Port Position as of July 25, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Twin*	*9,797*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered July 19*
2	*Winca*	*5,964*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered July 20*
Total Tonnage		**15,761**		

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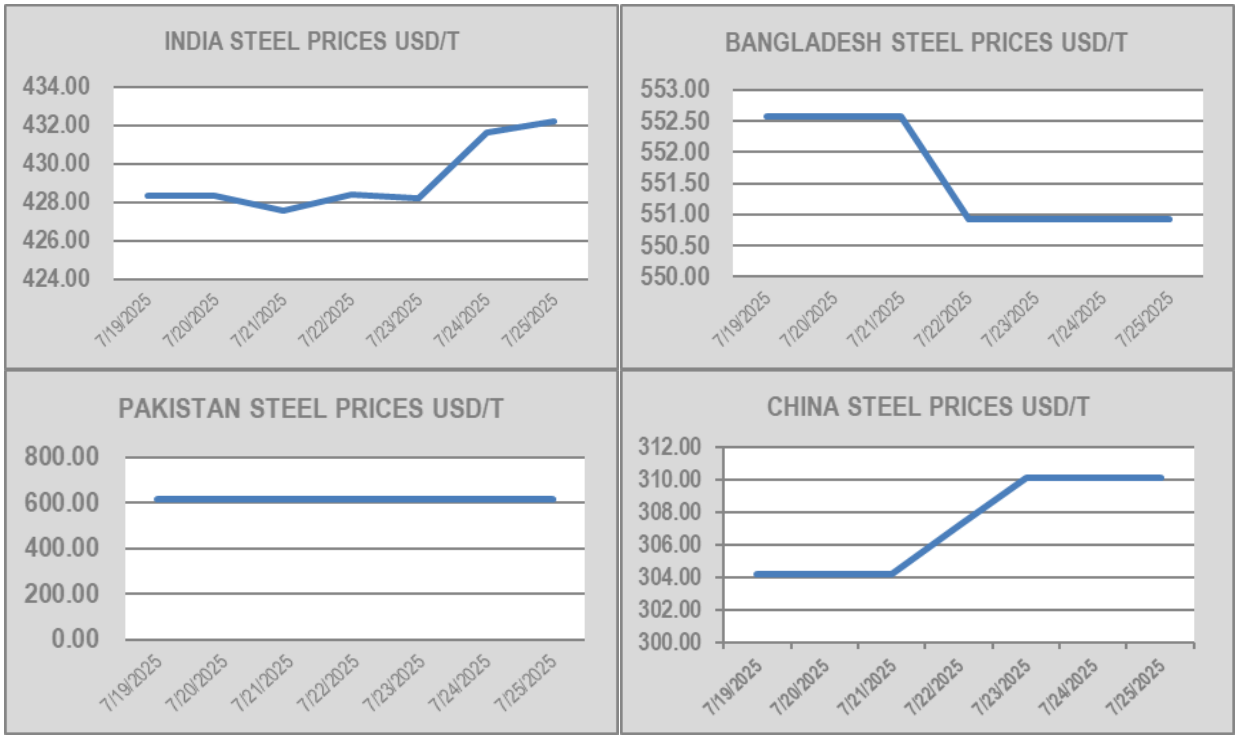
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
7/19/2025	428.32	36,900.00	615.44	175,000.00	552.58	67,000.00	304.20
7/20/2025	428.32	36,900.00	615.44	175,000.00	552.58	67,000.00	304.20
7/21/2025	427.58	36,900.00	615.44	175,000.00	552.58	67,000.00	304.20
7/22/2025	428.44	37,000.00	615.44	175,000.00	550.93	66,800.00	307.16
7/23/2025	428.19	37,000.00	615.44	175,000.00	550.93	66,800.00	310.16
7/24/2025	431.66	37,300.00	615.44	175,000.00	550.93	66,800.00	310.16
7/25/2025	432.22	37,400.00	615.44	175,000.00	550.93	66,800.00	310.16



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